Illinois Small-Town Grant Deadline Calendar

Deadlines after Fri, Nov 20, 2026, plus programs that take applications year-round

Each line repeats what the program's official notice says: the deadline, the award, the match and who can apply. Every fact was checked against the official notice on Thu, Nov 12, 2026. Open the link and read the notice before you apply.

November 2026

Deadline	Program	Award	Match	Who can apply (per the notice)
Mon, Nov 30, 2026, 11:59 PM CT	FY27 Small Equipment Grant Illinois Office of the State Fire Marshal	Up to $50,000 for small firefighting and ambulance equipment	0% cash and 0% in-kind match	Fire departments, fire protection districts and not-for-profit ambulance services
Mon, Nov 30, 2026	Spark Good Local Grants (FY27, Cycle 3) Walmart Foundation	$250 – $5,000	Not stated in the notice	Political subdivisions, including cities, counties and municipal agencies (volunteer fire companies are not eligible)

December 2026

Deadline	Program	Award	Match	Who can apply (per the notice)
Tue, Dec 15, 2026, 5:00 PM CT	Community Partnership for Deflection and Substance Use Disorder Treatment Illinois Criminal Justice Information Authority (ICJIA)	$100,000 – $250,000 per applicant (the notice's minimum and maximum request)	No match (notice: "Cost Sharing or Matching N/A")	Illinois law enforcement agencies, other first responder entities and local government agencies
Thu, Dec 17, 2026: project narrative and budget to the State Forester; Grants.gov by Tue, Jan 26, 2027, 11:59 PM ET	Landscape Scale Restoration USDA Forest Service (State Forester sponsorship: Illinois DNR)	$100,000 – $300,000 for a single-state project ($600,000 is the cap for multi-state projects only)	50% non-federal match	Units of local government (and others); work must be on rural non-industrial private, state or local government forest land
Thu, Dec 31, 2026, 5:00 PM CT	CPRG Stretch Code Adoption, Round 4 Illinois Finance Authority / Climate Bank	Up to $200,000 per municipality applying alone; up to $1,000,000 only for a group application of five or more municipalities	0% cash match	Cities, villages and incorporated towns only
Thu, Dec 31, 2026 (Grants.gov close date)	Solid Waste Management Grants (FY27) USDA Rural Development	No minimum award; the notice caps each award at 25 percent of the funding available for this program	No cost sharing (Grants.gov)	Public bodies, nonprofits, tribes and academic institutions with the legal authority and actual capacity to provide solid-waste technical assistance and training on a regional basis (the help goes to rural areas and towns of 10,000 or less)

January 2027

Deadline	Program	Award	Match	Who can apply (per the notice)
Fri, Jan 22, 2027, 11:59 PM ET	DERA National Program 2026 (diesel emissions) U.S. EPA	Up to $8,000,000 per application for a project in EPA Region 5, which serves Illinois	Mandatory cost share; the share depends on the project type (NOFO Table 2)	A city or village qualifies only if it is a local agency with jurisdiction over transportation or air quality; townships and fire districts aren't named in the notice

March 2027

Deadline	Program	Award	Match	Who can apply (per the notice)
Mon, Mar 1, 2027, 5:00 PM CT	FY27 Residential Sharps Collection Illinois EPA	Actual costs of sharps collection and disposal, up to $35,000 per unit of local government	Not stated in the notice	Units of local government that operate a sharps collection station (GATA pre-qualified)
Next phase: Mon, Mar 1, 2027, 5:00 PM EST; final phase Wed, Sep 1, 2027, 5:00 PM EST	Innovative Traffic Safety Enforcement (ITSE) U.S. DOT, NHTSA	$500,000 – $2,000,000 per award (the notice's funding range for each award); one application per applicant per phase	No cost sharing required	A state or local agency (also authorities, associations, educational institutions and nonprofits) that shows it has the organizational capacity and experience to run the project

Year-round and rolling programs

Deadline	Program	Award	Match	Who can apply (per the notice)
Rolling: applications accepted October 1 – September 30	Community Facilities Direct Loan & Grant Program (direct loans) USDA Rural Development	Low-interest direct loans; repayment up to 40 years, never longer than the facility's useful life	Not stated in the notice	Public bodies in rural areas (cities, villages, townships and towns) with no more than 20,000 residents
Rolling: applications accepted October 1 – September 30	Water & Waste Disposal Loan & Grant Program (loans) USDA Rural Development (Illinois)	Long-term, low-interest loans; up to 40-year payback, based on the useful life of the facilities	Not stated in the notice	Rural areas and towns with populations of 10,000 or less
Rolling: no specific due date; first-come, first-served	CDBG Community Revitalization Illinois DCEO	Up to $1,000,000 for sidewalk improvements; a single commercial building up to $250,000; large structures up to $2,000,000	No match required	Cities, villages, townships and counties (units of general local government). To qualify under the low-to-moderate income national objective, the proposed project must benefit at least 51.0 percent low-to-moderate income (LMI) persons.
Rolling: no specific due date	CDBG Economic Development Illinois DCEO	$300,000 – $1,000,000 (no more than $25,000 per job created or $10,000 per job retained)	Cost sharing required; other funding must be firmly committed	Cities, villages and counties, on behalf of a business that creates or keeps jobs
Rolling: no specific due date; DCEO must receive the application within six months of the Gubernatorial Disaster Declaration	CDBG Disaster Response Illinois DCEO	Up to $250,000 per unit of local government	No match per the state grant listing; the NOFO supplement asks that at least 25% of project costs come from other non-Department funds (a written waiver request is allowed)	Units of local government covered by a Gubernatorial Disaster Declaration
Rolling: no submission deadlines; open until a new NOFO is published or funds run out	Public Works & Economic Adjustment Assistance U.S. Economic Development Administration	The notice states no per-applicant cap. Its FY2025 ranges: Public Works $600,000 – $5 million; Economic Adjustment Assistance $150,000 – $2.5 million	EDA pays up to 60% of project cost (up to 80% in more distressed regions)	A city, county or other political subdivision of a state (also tribes, nonprofits and others); the project region must meet EDA's economic distress criteria
Rolling: accepted until funding is spent	Lead Service Line Inventory (LSLI) Grant, Round 4 Illinois EPA	$20,000 – $50,000 per applicant, set by number of service connections	No match	GATA pre-qualified local government units with a median household income below 120% of the state average

Deadline	Program	Award	Match	Who can apply (per the notice)
Rolling: accepted until funding is spent	Unsewered Communities Planning Grant, Round 3 Illinois EPA	Up to $30,000 per applicant (the cap steps down to $17,500 as local median household income rises)	Not stated in the notice	Local government units in Illinois (as defined in 35 Ill. Adm. Code Part 662), for a Project Plan to solve wastewater collection and treatment needs
Rolling	IRA Urban & Community Forestry Illinois DNR (USDA Forest Service pass-through)	Not stated in the notice	Match required	Government organizations and nonprofits, for trees, forests and green spaces in and next to cities and towns
First-come, first-served; listing closes Mon, Jan 31, 2028	Driving a Cleaner Illinois, DERA (diesel truck replacement) Illinois EPA (U.S. EPA DERA pass-through)	Up to 45% of eligible costs to replace (not repower) a diesel Class 5-8 truck	55% cash match	Government organizations, nonprofits and businesses that have owned and operated the truck being scrapped for two full years

Compiled by Deadline Sweep, a free weekly email of grant deadlines for small Illinois towns, townships and fire districts: deadlinesweep.com